

Whispers,

i dig for the why
i dig until my nails split
i dig through black soil that smells like rust
i dig through bone shards and wet roots
i dig until there is nothing in my hands
but dust and a taste that is too much like blood

i live here now
i live where the air does not move
i live where silence crushes the skull
until you can hear the red inside your veins
i live where waiting is the only motion

they pull my chest open
they pull until something gives
they pull and the muscle groans
then shove it back in
still hot still shaking
and i carry it like a stone that grinds my ribs from the inside

i hear your whispers.
i hear them until my own breath sounds wrong.